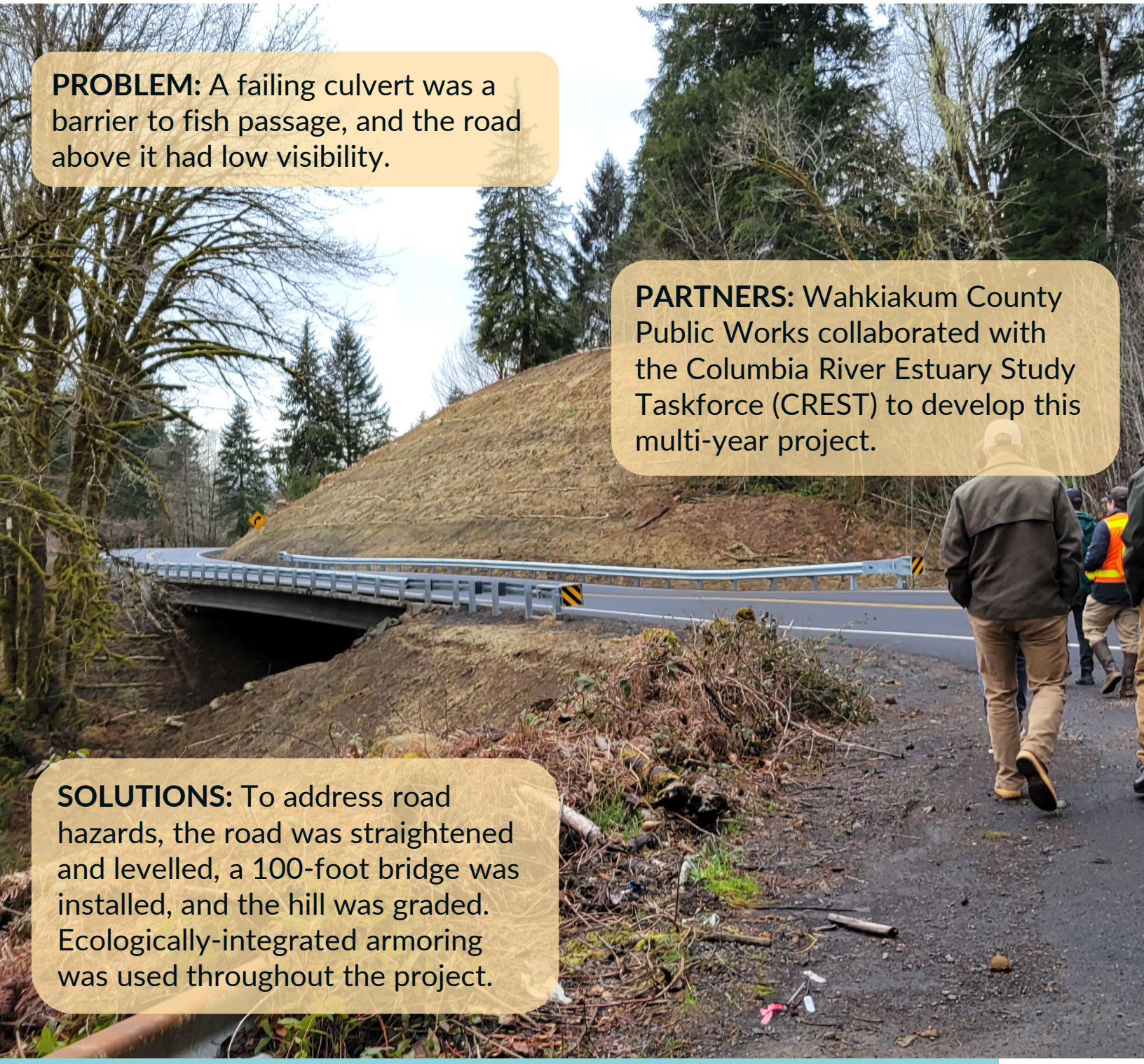
WAHKIAKUM COMMON GROUND

Success Story: Clear Creek

A small, failing culvert under Elochoman Valley Road blocked fish passage. Road conditions were unsafe for log truck and other drivers. Through a multi-year project, safety for people and fish was enhanced through the installation of a new, channel-spanning bridge and in-stream elements.



PROBLEM: A failing culvert was a barrier to fish passage, and the road above it had low visibility.

PARTNERS: Wahkiakum County Public Works collaborated with the Columbia River Estuary Study Taskforce (CREST) to develop this multi-year project.

SOLUTIONS: To address road hazards, the road was straightened and levelled, a 100-foot bridge was installed, and the hill was graded. Ecologically-integrated armoring was used throughout the project.

Want to know more? Visit https://beav.es/WCG

Wahkiakum County MRC

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CHALLENGES: The permitting process took a long time, and construction required coordination with landowners and neighbors to minimize disruptions. The project was expensive and needed several funders.

BENEFITS: To improve fish habitat, passage, and reduce sedimentation, the project included woody structures, refugia pools, and preservation of the tree canopy.

LESSONS LEARNED

Strong communication and flexibility are critical for multi-year efforts. The project was successful because the design accounted for landowner needs in addition to fish habitat needs. Funding to improve conditions for fish can also improve public safety.

PROJECT PARTNERS & FUNDERS

Private Landowners
Wahkiakum County Public Works
Columbia River Estuary Study Taskforce (CREST)
Lower Columbia Engineering
WA Salmon Recovery Funding Board (RCO)
Brian Abbot Fish Barrier Removal Board (RCO)
Puget Sound Acquisition and Restoration (RCO)

***Wahkiakum County** relies on a healthy salmon fishery for commercial, tribal, and recreational purposes, yet salmon populations are threatened. Efforts to support sustainable fisheries by restoring watersheds also have benefits for the community: reducing risk from coastal hazards, boosting economic vitality, and improving emergency preparedness.*

To learn about multi-benefit watershed restoration **SUCCESS STORIES** in Wahkiakum County or to **get involved** visit:

https://beav.es/WCG